

ping of video files into the GraphEdit interface shows a graphical representation of how the video file is rendered. One can easily change the filters (by the drag and drop method) and test the output as well.

GSpot is a tool that tells you the type of codec needed to play an audio or video file. It also tells you if the system has the required codec installed. Dragging and dropping or opening a media file tells you the length of the movie, frame rate, bitrate, total frames, screen ratio, and more details. LameDropXPd allows you to encode a file to the MP3 format by just dragging and dropping audio files into a little iconic interface.

A tool called Sherlock informs you about the audio and video codecs installed, their versions, and all the details of each codec. VobSubStrip shows a list of subtitles of .vob files (DVD movies). Selecting the subtitle stream rips that subtitle from the movie!

6.5 Avast! Home Edition 4.7

Avast!, unlike most anti-virus software, has a user interface that more or less looks like a media player. Specific areas like removable media, folders, and local disks can be scanned. The sensitivity of the scan can be changed using the pop-up slider.

There are three levels of sensitivity—Quick Scan, Standard Scan and Thorough Scan. One can start, pause, and stop scanning by clicking media-player-like icons.

Resident Protection continuously scans for virus-like activity in the system. In Standard mode, Resident Protection checks for executables when one runs



Avast!'s easy interface is even skinnable